PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

Proposed Solution

Date	11 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-7837
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

1. Problem Overview

The Standard Laptop Procurement process can require manual creation and assignment of a Catalog Task after a Standard Laptop request is approved. Manual intervention can create delays, reduce task visibility, increase the possibility of errors, and make the processing of approved requests less consistent.

2. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is a ServiceNow Flow Designer automation that connects the Service Catalog, Requested Items, Approvals, Flow Designer, and Catalog Tasks into a simple end-to-end procurement workflow. When a Standard Laptop request is approved, the flow automatically creates a Catalog Task and assigns it to the Hardware team for configuration.

3. Solution Workflow

Stage	Process	System Action	Result
1	Standard Laptop Request	User submits the Standard Laptop request through the Service Catalog.	Requested Item is created.
2	Approval	The request proceeds through the approval process.	Approval outcome is available.
3	Approval Condition	Flow Designer evaluates the approved request.	Approved Standard Laptop request proceeds to automation.
4	Catalog Task Creation	Flow Designer creates the required Catalog Task.	Actionable hardware task is generated.
5	Hardware Assignment	Flow Designer assigns the Catalog Task to the Hardware team.	Correct team receives the task.
6	Configuration	Hardware team works on the assigned Catalog Task.	Laptop configuration can begin promptly.

4. Key Solution Components

Component	Purpose in the Proposed Solution
Service Catalog	Provides the entry point for submitting the Standard Laptop procurement request.
Requested Item	Represents the requested Standard Laptop item and provides the request context for processing.
Approval Process	Determines whether the Standard Laptop request is approved and ready for the next workflow stage.
Flow Designer	Provides the automation logic that connects approval to Catalog Task creation and assignment.
Catalog Task	Provides the actionable work item for Standard Laptop configuration.
Hardware Team	Receives the generated Catalog Task and performs the laptop configuration activity.

5. How the Solution Addresses the Problem

Existing Challenge	Solution Response	Expected Improvement
Manual Catalog Task creation	Flow Designer automatically creates the Catalog Task after approval.	Less manual effort and fewer processing delays.
Manual task assignment	The flow assigns the Catalog Task to the Hardware team.	Correct team receives the task without manual routing.
Poor task visibility	The automated process creates an actionable Catalog Task.	Improved visibility of the next procurement activity.
Manual errors and inconsistency	A defined Flow Designer workflow applies the same logic to the automated path.	More consistent processing and reduced manual errors.

6. Expected Benefits

• Eliminates manual creation of the Catalog Task after Standard Laptop approval.

• Automatically assigns the generated task to the Hardware team.

• Improves visibility of the next procurement activity.

• Reduces delays between approval and hardware configuration.

• Minimizes manual errors and supports consistent processing.

• Enables the Hardware team to begin laptop configuration promptly.

• Provides a simple end-to-end automated procurement workflow within ServiceNow.

7. Solution Scope

The proposed solution is limited to the project functionality described: automating the creation of a Catalog Task when a Standard Laptop request is approved and assigning the task to the Hardware team. No additional procurement features, external systems, or unsupported automation capabilities are included.

8. Conclusion

The proposed ServiceNow Flow Designer solution provides a direct and practical response to the identified Standard Laptop procurement problem. By automating the transition from approval to Catalog Task creation and Hardware team assignment, it reduces manual work, improves visibility, minimizes delays and errors, and supports a consistent procurement workflow.